

Leadership Recommendation — Accounting First

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Status: Recommend Accounting as the first commercial integration investment, **subject to discovery validation**.

Technical proving ground: FieldFlow field-service connector prototype (reliability patterns reusable).

1. Decision and target users

Decision: Prioritize **Accounting** integration next (invoice/bill sync and reconciliation), not payments/funding and not insight-only products as the first commercial bet.

Primary users

Audience	Why they care
Finance operations / AP-AR	Fewer manual invoice/bill touches; cleaner exception queues
Implementation & support	Repeatable sync + reconciliation playbooks
Customers needing accounting sync	Faster close visibility without reinventing field ops

Interview signal retained: **transaction creation must precede payments**, and invoice automation requires **human approval boundaries**.

2. Business value

Value lever	Effect
Automated transaction creation	Invoices/bills enter the system of record without re-keying
Lower manual touch / error cost	Fewer exceptions from transcription and status drift
Faster reconciliation / close / cash visibility	Ops sees sync state and blockers earlier
Retention & expansion	Sticky finance workflow once trust is earned

Field service remains strategically useful as **ops glue** and as the engineering pattern library (inbox/outbox/idempotency/circuit/health). It is not the strongest first **finance ROI** narrative for this investment decision.

3. MVP (and hard non-goals)

MVP includes

- Invoice/bill **transaction creation** into accounting
- Sync **status** visibility (healthy / degraded / exception)
- Reconciliation + **exception handling** queue
- Human approval for high-risk actions

MVP excludes

- Automatic **payment** movement / funding rails
- Closed-period writebacks without finance controls
- Replacing the ERP as system of record

4. Sequence and timeline assumptions

Assumptions — not a committed program plan.

Phase	Focus	Exit signal (assumption)
1. Discovery / data contract	Chart of accounts, tax, entities, period rules	Signed field map + ownership
2. Core transaction sync	Create/update invoice/bill + status	Pilot tenants create without dual-entry
3. Exceptions / reconciliation	Mismatch queue, replay, audit	Exception rate under target
4. Controlled pilot	One provider + limited customers	Finance signs control review
5. Scale decision	Expand providers/tenants or pause	ROI inputs validated

5. Dependencies, risks, and assumptions

Item	Note
Closed accounting periods	Writes must respect period locks
Supplemental transactions	Credit memos / adjustments need explicit rules
Provider API maturity	Auth, idempotency, webhooks, SLAs vary
Customer concentration	ROI sensitive to a few large accounts
Security / compliance	Finance data heightens review bar
Delivery capacity	Connector patterns exist; accounting domain rules still TBD

Risk: shipping payments/funding first creates compliance and irreversible-money risk before accounting truth is solid.

6. Success measures (targets / assumptions)

All thresholds are **targets pending PRG baselines** — not measured facts.

Measure	Target assumption
Manual touch minutes per invoice/bill	↓ ≥ 50% vs baseline
Exception rate on synced transactions	< 5% after pilot stabilize
Time-to-visible sync failure	< 15 minutes (health + alerts)
Dual-entry incidents in pilot	0 material duplicates
Finance control review	Pass before scale

7. ROI methodology (transparent; no invented PRG figures)

Do **not** invent PRG volumes, labour rates, or revenue. Use discovery inputs in:

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Annual benefit =
  (volume × minutes saved × loaded labour rate)
+ error costs avoided
+ cash-flow / retention benefit
- build and operating cost
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Input	Source required
Volume	Monthly invoice/bill count in scope
Minutes saved	Time study / SME estimate
Loaded labour rate	Finance ops cost model
Error costs avoided	Rework, credit notes, write-offs
Cash-flow / retention	Finance + CS judgment (label as assumption)
Build + operating cost	Eng + vendor + support run-rate

Commit only after the formula is populated with PRG data — not narrative alone.

8. Why not first (without dismissing value)

Option	Keep the value	Why not first
Field service	Proven here as reliability spine; ops efficiency	Narrower finance ROI story vs accounting sync
Signal ingestion	Rich operational signal	Insight without accounting backbone under-delivers cash/close impact
Call intelligence	Transcript/summary upside	Depends on AI quality + downstream actionability; weaker immediate AP/AR ROI
Funding / payments	High strategic upside later	Highest risk/compliance; needs accounting truth + approval controls first

9. Information required before final commitment

1. Invoice/bill **volumes** and seasonality
 2. Current **touch time** and labour rates
 3. Exception / error baselines and cost
 4. Provider and customer **concentration**
 5. Willingness to pay / packaging
 6. Accounting provider **API, security, SLA** evidence
 7. Delivery capacity and finance ownership for period controls
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10. Relationship to the FieldFlow prototype

The prototype intentionally proves reusable connector mechanics (identity, inbox/outbox, idempotency, ordering, DLQ/replay, circuit/health, audit). Accounting should **reuse those patterns** behind new capability ports — not rebuild reliability from scratch — while adding finance-domain rules the field-service mock does not encode.